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Revision exercises

Complete the summary

As a review of the topic, attempt to complete the following exercise in your notebook.

Alexander was born in _____ BC. His father was _____, king of Macedon. His mother was _____. His early life was influenced by the famous philosopher _____ and his tutor _____. At the age of 16 he fought at the battle of _____ in _____ BC. He became king of Macedon in _____ BC. He inherited a highly trained and efficient _____. He used this to win the battles of _____ in 334 BC; _____ in 333 BC; _____ in 331 BC and at the River _____ in 326 BC. He also managed to win important sieges at _____ in 332 BC and _____ in the same year.

In _____ BC Alexander founded the city of _____ in Egypt. He visited the oracle and temple of _____ before leaving Egypt. After defeating the Persian king _____ in 331 BC he marched to the Persian city of _____ and burnt it as an act of revenge.

Alexander angered the older, more conservative Macedonians by starting to adopt Persian customs such as _____ and _____. He also started to integrate Persian _____ into the army.

Macedonian resentment to Alexander's new policies resulted in three famous events: _____

Usually Alexander was very popular with his army. This was because _____

The Macedonian army twice showed that it was unhappy by _____ at _____ in _____ BC and at _____ in BC. Alexander's decision to _____ the fleet in _____ BC and to march back from India through the _____ desert in _____ BC are often seen as examples of poor strategic judgment.

Two of the main ancient sources on Alexander's campaign and life are _____ and _____.

Revision questions

- 1 What do we know about Alexander's early life?
- 2 What problems did Alexander have to overcome as soon as he became king of Macedon?
- 3 Why did Alexander invade Persia?
- 4 Describe the army led by Alexander that conquered the Persian Empire.
- 5 What happened at the Battle of Granicus?
- 6 What happened at the Battle of Issus?
- 7 What happened at the siege of Tyre?
- 8 Why did Alexander go to the Oracle of Zeus Ammon at Siwah?
- 9 What happened at the Battle of Gaugamela?
- 10 Why was Alexander able to defeat the Persians?
- 11 Why did Alexander burn the city of Persepolis?
- 12 What happened at the Battle of Hydaspes?
- 13 Why did the Macedonian nobles and Greeks become unhappy with Alexander?
- 14 What happened after Alexander's death?
- 15 Does Alexander deserve to be called 'the Great'?